



Fig. 3: Symbol library for ZenitParts

footprint easier. Design rule checker considers the rules to be followed while placing elements in a PCB, like the clearance between board outline, tracks, pads, components and text.

ZenitParts

ZenitParts is a simple tool that allows you to quickly create and modify parts and symbols for PCB designing purposes. The user-friendly and intuitive UI, very similar to that of ZenitCapture schematic, makes this program easy to understand and use. The created parts and symbols can be easily saved to the library of our choice. It also allows you to modify the items already provided in the library, copy, delete and rename them.

ZenitPCB GerberView

The default file format *.zpc created in ZenitPCB Layout can be exported to Gerber and NC Drill file formats from

Gerber is an open, 2D vector image file format used by PCB designing software used to store and communicate design information such as copper layers, drill holes and solder mask.

The Excellon NC Drill is a file format that is used in PCB drilling and routing purposes, and defines machine-specific information such as the drill feed and speed.

File > Export and selecting the option required. This opens the *Generate Gerber Files* or *NC Drill Format* dialogue box accordingly. Along with the Gerber and NC Drill file, the system creates an ASCII file with the name and folder of the Gerber or NC Drill files. Once this is done, click on the *Open GerberView* icon from below the menu bar to open the *ZenitPCB GerberView* window, and it displays the Gerber format according to the ASCII file.

The GerberView has options to hide and view separate layers or all at once. This makes analysing and editing easier for the design. The colour view of each layer can be configured according to the user's preferences. When *Overlay Display Color* is activated, it can control the transparency of various layers so that the user can observe more layers at the same time.

Steps for creating PCB design

Here are the basic steps that need to be followed when you are designing a PCN using ZenitPCB suite: First place the components in ZenitCapture. Route all the components. Package the parts and create a netlist. Now create a new project or open an existing one in

Licence type	Freeware
Developer	StortiniMiro Bruno, www.zenitpcb.com
Latest version	1.8
Operating system	Windows (all versions)
Disk space	33.8MB (excluding resources required to save the results)

ZenitPCB Layout, place a board outline (*Place > Board Outline > Wizard... / Polyline*). Import the netlist from *File > Import > Netlist...* option. Now you can route the circuit to create a suitable PCB design.

On an alternate method, you can directly design without creating schematic, by importing and/or editing components from library using *File* menu.

Easy user interface and detailed help files

The basic steps for designing using ZenitPCB suite are very simple and require little documentation. But if you had selected to install help file along with the package, then you can get access to an elaborate help file that guides you to create a PCB design right from the beginning. The help window can be opened by pressing the function key F1. The download page of the developer site www.zenitpcb.com also has a collection of video tutorials. Both these would help a novice engineer to get through the design process without much trouble. For more tips, advices and guidance, you could send a mail to support@zenitpcb.com. ●

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